

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Education Administration English



Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For school administrators, curriculum coordinators, student-services staff, program directors, admissions teams, registrars, and education operations leaders.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Enrollment, Admissions, and Placement

Clarify missing information before responding.

02 Curriculum Planning and Learning Outcomes

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

03 Student Support and Intervention

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

04 Parent and Guardian Communication

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

05 Faculty Coordination and Evaluation

Describe observed behavior, its effect, and a useful next step.

06 Compliance, Records, and Privacy

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

07 Accreditation and Program Review

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

08 Budget, Staffing, and Institutional Priorities

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | 05 • Conversations

Read one ten-turn conversation aloud, notice a useful expression, then compare the other two. Identify each speaker's purpose and how the exchange ends.

35-47 minutes | 06 • Say it

Rehearse both speaking scenarios from the workbook. Give two minutes of preparation, switch roles, and use the success checks. Add the complication only after a successful first round.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, study one complete conversation and rehearse one scenario; assign the others for oral follow-up. For 90 minutes, rehearse all three conversations and give both scenarios a second round. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Enrollment, Admissions, and Placement

Clarify missing information before responding.

CASE

A family asks why an applicant was not offered a place. The administrator needs to explain the published process without discussing other applicants.

Teach this move

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Vocabulary to check: admissions criteria, placement, capacity, equity.

Model response

I can explain the published criteria and the next steps available for this application. Which part of the decision notice would you like me to clarify? I cannot discuss another applicant's record.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Second-round challenge

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Language-check answers

1. B - Could you confirm when the review starts? The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".
2. A - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review? This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

05 • Conversations

1. Explain the applicant's process, not other applicants - Fictional admissions inquiry using the lesson case: a family asks why an applicant was not offered a place; the administrator has not reviewed the applicant-specific decision record.
2. Language placement is not an admissions decision - Fictional school inquiry: an admitted learner awaits a language-placement review, and a family liaison asks whether admission itself is uncertain.

3. A waiting-list position is not an offer date - Fictional enrollment discussion: a family has been told their applicant is on a waiting list; no future opening or offer date is confirmed.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A transfer request with an unclear start date

A fictional family asks to transfer a learner next term, but the request does not identify the program or whether they mean the first day or a later date. Capacity and placement review are unconfirmed. Clarify the request before discussing availability.

Role A: Enrollment coordinator: ask for the intended program and timing.

Role B: Family liaison: relay the request and identify missing information without promising a place.

Possible opening: Could you clarify which program and start date the family is asking us to consider?

Success checks

- Clarify program and timing separately.
- Keep capacity and placement unconfirmed.
- Agree the next admissions inquiry without an offer promise.

Add a complication: The liaison asks to reserve a place before the program is identified.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Curriculum Planning and Learning Outcomes

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

CASE

A curriculum plan lists topics but no observable learning outcomes. Teachers disagree about what an assessment should measure.

Teach this move

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

Vocabulary to check: learning outcome, curriculum map, assessment, standard.

Model response

A topic says what we cover; an outcome says what learners should be able to do. Let's define those performances first, then check whether the assessment gives learners a chance to demonstrate them.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Second-round challenge

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Language-check answers

1. A - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed. This gives the meaning in familiar words.
2. C - How would you describe the next step in your own words? An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

05 • Conversations

1. A topic is not an observable learning outcome - Fictional curriculum meeting using the lesson case: a plan lists topics, but teachers disagree about what the assessment should measure.
2. Completing an activity does not prove the outcome - Fictional curriculum review: learners completed a group poster, while the intended outcome is explaining a cause-and-effect relationship individually.

3. Coverage in a curriculum map is not depth of learning - Fictional program review: a topic appears in three units of a curriculum map, but the intended progression between units is unspecified.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Understand data needs a clearer performance

A fictional unit lists understand data as its learning outcome. Teachers have proposed either reading a chart aloud or explaining a comparison between two values. Neither task is approved. Discuss which observable performance matches the intended learning.

Role A: Curriculum coordinator: ask what understanding should look like.

Role B: Teacher: explain the difference between reading values and interpreting a comparison.

Possible opening: What should learners be able to demonstrate when we say they understand the data?

Success checks

- Distinguish attendance, activity, and learning evidence.
- Propose an observable outcome.
- Keep assessment approval pending the curriculum review.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to treat attendance at the lesson as evidence of achievement.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Student Support and Intervention

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

CASE

A support meeting has attendance information but no record of which interventions have already been tried.

Teach this move

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Vocabulary to check: intervention, accommodation, attendance, student support.

Model response

Could you bring the relevant attendance pattern and the support actions already attempted? We can use those records to plan the discussion and avoid repeating an approach without reviewing its effect.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Second-round challenge

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Language-check answers

1. C - Send it no later than Thursday. 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.
2. B - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review? The requested action and information are explicit.

05 · Conversations

1. Attendance records do not show previous support - Fictional student-support meeting using the lesson case: attendance information is available, but previously attempted interventions are undocumented.
2. A suggested check-in has not started - Fictional support review: a weekly student check-in was proposed, but the staff owner and start date were never confirmed.

3. Request evidence about a classroom arrangement - Fictional support discussion: a quieter work location was offered during two lessons; no observation of its effect has been recorded.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Two staff may be offering the same support

A fictional learner may be receiving similar organizational check-ins from two staff members. The schedule and purpose of each are unconfirmed. Request coordination before adding a third session; do not infer needs or effectiveness.

Role A: Support coordinator: ask for the existing support schedule and purpose.

Role B: Year tutor: identify the relevant staff contacts and keep gaps explicit.

Possible opening: Before adding another session, could we confirm what support is already happening and what each check-in is intended to address?

Success checks

- Request existing support facts before proposing more.
- Avoid assuming effectiveness or duplication is confirmed.
- Agree a privacy-conscious coordination step.

Add a complication: A colleague says more sessions must always be better.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Parent and Guardian Communication

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

CASE

A guardian says an email sounded accusatory. The school intended to request a meeting about repeated late arrivals.

Teach this move

Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

Vocabulary to check: guardian communication, discipline, appeal, confidentiality.

Model response

I'm sorry the wording sounded accusatory. The purpose is to understand the late arrivals and discuss support. Could we arrange a time to review the pattern and hear your perspective?

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision takes responsibility for the message without blaming the listener. It identifies what needs to be corrected.

Second-round challenge

The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Language-check answers

1. B - I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear. This acknowledges the speaker's contribution to the problem.
2. A - The corrected date and the current confirmation status. A repair needs usable corrected information, including any uncertainty.

05 • Conversations

1. Replace the accusatory late-arrival email - Fictional guardian communication using the lesson case: a guardian found an email accusatory; the intended purpose was to request a meeting about repeated late arrivals.
2. A group email revealed an individual concern - Fictional communication repair: an administrator sent a meeting request about one learner to a broader staff group than intended; sharing authorization is under review.

3. A pending decision was presented as final - Fictional school exchange: a message described a proposed timetable change as final, although review of a family's concern is still pending.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Urgent sounded like an emergency

A fictional school email used Urgent in its subject for a routine scheduling meeting. A guardian became worried. No emergency or disciplinary decision exists in this case. Correct the wording and agree how to arrange the meeting.

Role A: School administrator: acknowledge the unnecessary alarm and state the routine purpose.

Role B: Family liaison: ask for a clear opening and meeting-arrangement next step.

Possible opening: I'm sorry the subject line caused alarm; this is a routine scheduling discussion, not an emergency.

Success checks

- Acknowledge the sender's wording problem.
- State only the supplied routine purpose.
- Agree a clear scheduling contact without blaming the guardian.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to blame the guardian for misunderstanding the subject.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Faculty Coordination and Evaluation

Describe observed behavior, its effect, and a useful next step.

CASE

Two teachers use different interpretations of the same grading rubric. Students receive inconsistent explanations.

Teach this move

Use a specific example instead of a personality label. Explain its effect, invite the person's perspective, and agree on a practical improvement. Focus on communication that can be changed, not accent or national identity.

Vocabulary to check: rubric, grading policy, observation, professional development.

Model response

Let's compare the descriptors against the same sample of work. Where do our interpretations differ? We can agree on clearer explanations and examples before using the rubric again.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision identifies observable work. 'Always' and a personality judgment make the feedback harder to verify or act on.

Second-round challenge

The recipient disagrees with your interpretation. Return to the observed example, listen, and revise an unsupported assumption.

Language-check answers

1. A - The last two updates omitted the agreed completion date. The recipient can check the specific examples and discuss how to improve them.
2. C - What is making this part of the task difficult? An open question may reveal a barrier the speaker has not considered.

05 • Conversations

1. Two rubric interpretations need calibration - Fictional faculty coordination using the lesson case: two teachers interpret the same rubric differently and give inconsistent explanations to students.

2. An observation note needs a concrete behavior - Fictional faculty feedback: an observation note says a teacher did not engage learners; the observer recorded no learner counts but noted one unanswered invitation to speak.

3. Different feedback at the same rubric level - Fictional marking review: two teachers awarded the same rubric level, but one wrote needs more evidence and the other wrote explain your examples.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A rubric level is explained as effort

A fictional rubric describes evidence quality, but one feedback comment explains a level as worked hard. The learner's work has not yet been reviewed by the coordinator. Discuss the mismatch without changing the grade prematurely.

Role A: Assessment coordinator: identify the difference between the criterion and the comment.

Role B: Teacher: clarify intended feedback and agree a work-based review.

Possible opening: The rubric addresses evidence quality, but this comment explains the level in terms of effort.

Success checks

- Describe the observable wording mismatch.
- Avoid inferring the grade is wrong without review.
- Agree a criterion-based feedback check.

Add a complication: A colleague asks you to change the grade before examining the work.

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Compliance, Records, and Privacy

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

CASE

A colleague asks for an entire student file for a narrow administrative task. The authorized scope is unclear.

Teach this move

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Vocabulary to check: FERPA, student record, need to know, secure handling.

Model response

Could you identify the purpose and the specific records needed? Let's confirm the permitted access and sharing process before providing information from the file.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Second-round challenge

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Language-check answers

1. C - Send it no later than Thursday. 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.
2. B - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review? The requested action and information are explicit.

05 • Conversations

1. A narrow task does not establish full-file access - Fictional records request using the lesson case: a colleague asks for an entire student file for a narrow task, but authorized scope is unclear.
2. A spreadsheet export includes unnecessary fields - Fictional school administration: a room-allocation task needs class counts, but a proposed export includes student names and personal contact details.

3. The requested recipient is not yet verified - Fictional records inquiry: an email asks a school to send a learner's attendance record to a new address; recipient authority is unverified.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A printed roster left for collection

A fictional administrator wants to leave a student roster at an open reception desk for another staff member. The receiving person's authorization and approved collection method are unconfirmed. Request a secure-handling check before arranging collection.

Role A: Records coordinator: ask who needs the roster and for which task.

Role B: Office administrator: clarify the purpose and contact the authorized records owner.

Possible opening: Before leaving the roster for collection, could we confirm the recipient's need and the approved handover method?

Success checks

- Separate packaging from authorization and secure handling.
- Request the specific recipient and purpose.
- Keep handover pending the applicable review.

Add a complication: The administrator says an envelope alone proves the arrangement is appropriate.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Accreditation and Program Review

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

CASE

A program review action plan lists five actions. Three are complete, one is underway, and one has no assigned owner.

Teach this move

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

Vocabulary to check: accreditation, program review, evidence, action plan.

Model response

Three actions are complete and one is underway. The fifth needs an owner and a target date. I'll make that outstanding decision visible in the program review update.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Second-round challenge

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Language-check answers

1. B - The team has completed the review. 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.
2. A - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it. This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

05 • Conversations

1. Three complete, one underway, one without an owner - Fictional program review using the lesson case: an action plan has five actions; three are complete, one is underway, and one has no owner.
2. Evidence uploaded, review still pending - Fictional accreditation preparation: a department uploaded evidence files, but the review team has not assessed their coverage or relevance.

3. An action was performed, its effect is unassessed - Fictional program-review action: a revised orientation session was delivered, but the planned learner-feedback review has not occurred.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The action owner has changed roles

A fictional program-review action remains open. Its named owner has moved to another department, and no replacement has accepted responsibility. The action's deadline is next month. Give a status update and request ownership clarification.

Role A: Quality coordinator: explain the confirmed owner change and open responsibility.

Role B: Program director: ask what decision is needed without assuming the action is abandoned.

Possible opening: The action remains open, and its named owner has changed roles; replacement ownership is not yet confirmed.

Success checks

- Separate ownership maintenance from completion.
- State the existing deadline without inventing progress.
- Request a confirmed owner and follow-up checkpoint.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests marking the action complete to remove the outdated name.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Budget, Staffing, and Institutional Priorities

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

CASE

A department can open another class by reallocating staff or hiring temporary support. Each option affects workload differently.

Teach this move

Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Vocabulary to check: budget, staffing model, workload, sustainability.

Model response

Reallocation uses existing staff but changes their workload; temporary support adds cost and preparation needs. Let's compare the implications for learners and staff before choosing an option.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. 'Better' already has comparative meaning, so it does not need 'more'. Naming the criterion and tradeoff makes the comparison useful.

Second-round challenge

Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Language-check answers

1. A - Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less. 'Whereas' marks a contrast between two options.
2. C - An increase of one percentage point. Subtracting 6% from 7% gives one percentage point. The relative increase is about 16.7%.

05 · Conversations

1. Reallocate a teacher or hire temporary support - Separate fictional staffing case: another class needs six teaching hours weekly. Reallocation would remove six tutoring hours; temporary support would preserve tutoring but require budget approval and hiring. Neither option is approved.
2. A one-term grant does not establish recurring funding - Fictional school planning: one-term funding could support an additional workshop group; funding for later terms is unconfirmed.

3. Combine groups or add a session - Separate fictional program case: two groups of 10 learners share a subject. Combining them fits the room's stated capacity of 20; an extra session requires two additional staff hours. Learning and workload effects are unassessed.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Extend office hours or redistribute them

A fictional student office wants two extra evening hours weekly. One option shifts two existing morning hours; another adds paid hours. Morning demand, staff availability, and added funding are unconfirmed. Compare options for a bounded staffing proposal.

Role A: Office manager: explain the two coverage options.

Role B: Budget coordinator: ask about workload, service effects, and approval.

Possible opening: We can assess shifting two morning hours or adding paid evening hours, but the demand and staffing checks are still open.

Success checks

- Compare the same coverage and workload criteria.
- Name reduced morning service as a possible tradeoff, not a measured harm.
- Keep funding and staffing commitments conditional.

Add a complication: A colleague calls shifted hours cost-free without considering reduced morning access.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

US Department of Education: FERPA

<https://studentprivacy.ed.gov/ferpa>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.